

# NATIONAL DISASTER MANAGEMENT PLAN (NDMP)

Official Safety SOPs & Disaster Protocols - Ministry of Earth Sciences (MoES), India

## 1. Emergency Alert Classifications

The India Meteorological Department (IMD) issues color-coded weather warnings to alert the population and disaster response forces:

- **Red Alert (Take Action):** Extremely heavy rainfall (over 204.4 mm in 24 hours), severe cyclones, or extreme weather conditions. Direct danger to life and property. Disaster response units (NDRF, SDRF) are deployed immediately. Citizens must evacuate low-lying areas.
- **Orange Alert (Be Prepared):** Heavy to very heavy rainfall (115.6 mm to 204.4 mm), high-speed winds, or severe thunderstorms. Preparedness protocols are activated. Authorities monitor waterlogging and power line safety.
- **Yellow Alert (Watch):** Moderate rainfall (64.5 mm to 115.5 mm) or worsening weather. Keep updated with official bulletins.

## 2. Monsoon Safety Guidelines (NDRF Official)

- **Flooding & Waterlogging:** Avoid wading through waterlogged streets. Submerged live wires, open manholes, and contaminated water pose invisible, life-threatening hazards.
- **Lightning:** During thunderstorms, seek shelter in a sturdy building. Avoid standing under tall trees or near metal structures.
- **Cloudbursts:** If in hilly terrain during a cloudburst, immediately move to higher ground away from stream beds, rivers, and landslide-prone slopes.

## 3. Specific Protocols for Chennai Metro

Chennai is highly vulnerable to urban flooding during the Northeast Monsoon (NEM).

- Chennai Corporation establishes command centers. In case of waterlogging exceeding 1.5 feet, arterial roads are closed, and storm water drain pumps are activated.
- Citizens in Chennai low-lying zones (e.g., Velachery, Madipakkam) must move to designated NDRF relief camps when a Red Alert is declared.
- Emergency contact for Chennai Corporation Disaster Helpline: 1913.